



HARSH CAKE ZONE

BAKING MASTERCLASS

Complete Beginner to Professional

5-Module Comprehensive Course Notes

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Modules	5 Comprehensive Modules

"Precision, Passion & Professional Technique"



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01

MODULE

Course Introduction

Equipment Guide & Course Roadmap



Course Roadmap

Welcome to the **Complete Beginner to Professional Baking Masterclass**! Over 5 comprehensive modules, you will learn the exact science, recipes, and professional techniques used by top home bakers. Here is a quick overview of what you will master:

MODULE	TITLE	KEY TOPICS
Module 1	Course Introduction & Equipment Guide	Setting up your professional baking toolkit
Module 2	Master Sponges & Baking Science	Commercial eggless premix, Vanilla, Chocolate, Red Velvet, Fruit sponge
Module 3	Frosting, Ganache & Cake Assembly	Whipping cream, 1:1 & 1:2 Ganache, Slicing, Soaking, Sharp edges
Module 4	Gourmet Cupcakes & The Ultimate Brownie	Dome shaped cupcakes, fillings, dense fudgy dark chocolate brownie
Module 5	The Art of Chocolates	Compound vs. Couverture, Mix-ins, Center-filled, Storage & Transportation

The Master Equipment List

To bake professionally, you need the **right tools** — not a commercial kitchen. Below is your complete equipment list to build your bakery from scratch.

■ MEASURING, PREPARATION & HYGIENE

ITEM	PURPOSE / NOTE
Digital Weighing Scale	Mandatory! Never rely solely on cups.
Measuring Cups & Spoons Set	Standardized sets for small liquid and dry measurements.
Mixing Bowls	Set of 2–3 large bowls — Glass or Stainless Steel preferred.
Silicone Spatulas	For folding batters and scraping every last drop from bowls.
Wire Whisk	For blending dry ingredients and mixing wet liquids smoothly.
Flour Sieve (Channi)	Essential for aerating flour and cocoa powder.
Silicone Brush	For greasing tins, brownie pans, and brushing liquids.
Tissue Paper Box	For wiping piping nozzles, cleaning palette knives, and keeping boards spotless.

■ BAKING ESSENTIALS

ITEM	PURPOSE / NOTE
6-inch Round Aluminum Tin	Primary tin for half-kg cakes.
6-inch Square Tin	Crucial for cutting perfect brownies.



Cupcake / Muffin Tray	Standard 6-cavity or 12-cavity metal tray.
Paper Cupcake Liners	To line the muffin tray.
Good Quality Baking Paper	Brand: Ecobake. Avoid cheap parchment for brownies — it sticks!
Stovetop Setup	Heavy-bottomed Kadhai/Tawa + small steel ring/stand + tight-fitting Patila lid.

■ FROSTING & DECORATING

ITEM	PURPOSE / NOTE
Electric Hand Beater	Mandatory for whipping cream — minimum 250W to 300W.
Cake Turntable	Smoothly rotating stand for professional icing.
Serrated Bread Knife	Long jagged knife for slicing sponges without squishing.
Straight Palette Knife	For spreading and leveling cream on cake surfaces.
Offset (Bent) Palette Knife	Makes spreading cream much easier on sides.
Bench Scraper / Comb	Metal/plastic flat edge for smooth sides and sharp edges.
Piping Bags	Disposable plastic — buy a pack of 50 or 100.
Piping Nozzles	Start with 1M Star Nozzle (swirls & borders) + basic round nozzle.

■ CHOCOLATE MAKING TOOLS

ITEM	PURPOSE / NOTE
Plastic (Polycarbonate) Molds	Essential for shiny finish and center-filled chocolates. Get deep-cavity molds.
Microwave-Safe Bowls	Plastic or glass — for melting chocolate without burning.
Chocolate Scraper	To scrape excess chocolate off molds for clean edges.

■ PACKAGING & STORAGE

ITEM	PURPOSE / NOTE
Cake Boards	Buy 7-inch or 8-inch boards for half-kg cakes.
Tall Cake Boxes	Ensure enough height so decorations don't get crushed.
Cupcake Boxes	With cavity inserts to prevent frosting damage.
Chocolate Cavity Boxes	Sectioned boxes for gourmet chocolates.
Cling Wrap	Vital for wrapping sponges airtight and storing chocolate slabs.
Paper or Cloth Delivery Bags	Insulates cake and chocolate boxes from heat during transport.

■ ESSENTIAL FLAVORS & CONSUMABLES



ITEM	PURPOSE / NOTE
Vanilla Essence	Absolute must-have — use a good quality brand.
Other Essences	Strawberry, Pineapple, Paan, Rasmalai etc. based on preference.
Gel Food Colors	Always choose GEL over liquid — they don't thin out your batters.
Fruit Crushes	Strawberry, Pineapple, Blueberry — for layering cakes and center-filled chocolates.



02

MODULE

Master Sponges

Baking Science & The Eggless Premix System



The Science of Our Ingredients

Baking is chemistry! Before you bake, understand *why* each ingredient plays its specific role. This knowledge will help you troubleshoot and customize recipes confidently.

INGREDIENT	SCIENCE / PURPOSE
All-Purpose Flour (Maida)	Provides the structure/skeleton of the cake through gluten proteins.
Sugar	Does more than sweeten — holds moisture (keeping cake soft) and aids browning.
Corn Flour	The secret softening agent. Dilutes gluten in maida, making the crumb incredibly tender.
Citric Acid	Dry acid trigger. When wet ingredients are added, it reacts with baking soda to create CO ₂ .
Baking Soda & Baking Powder	Leavening agents. Baking powder gives slow heat-lift; baking soda (reacting with citric acid) gives instant lift.
Salt	Just a pinch enhances all sweet flavors and balances overall taste.
Refined Sunflower Oil	Provides fat for moisture. Must be tasteless and odorless. Mustard or peanut oil will ruin the cake.
Water vs. Milk	Water → longer shelf life (ideal for commercial orders). Milk → slightly richer taste but shorter shelf life.

Recipe 1: The Master Vanilla Premix (Dry Base)

Instead of measuring all dry ingredients every time, make this **Master Dry Mix** in advance and store it. You can instantly whip up a cake whenever you receive an order!

INGREDIENT	QUANTITY
All-Purpose Flour (Maida)	130g
Sugar (Normal or Caster)	120g
Corn Flour	2 tbsp
Baking Powder	1 tsp
Baking Soda	½ tsp
Citric Acid	¼ tsp
Salt	1 pinch

Method — Making the Premix

- 1 Measure all dry ingredients precisely using a digital weighing scale.
- 2 Transfer everything into a mixer-grinder jar.
- 3 Pulse in the mixer — this ensures sugar becomes fine and leavening agents are perfectly distributed.



- 4 Sieve the ground mixture 1–2 times. This aerates the flour (adds air) and makes the cake lighter.
- 5 Storage: Store in an airtight container in the fridge. Lasts for months!

Baking the Sponge (Yield: 500g Cake with Icing)

When ready to bake a standard **half-kg cake**, use the following formula to convert your stored premix into batter.

INGREDIENT	QUANTITY
Master Vanilla Premix	180g
Water or Milk	Add gradually — 'flowing ribbon' consistency
Flavorless Oil (Sunflower)	1 tbsp
Vanilla Essence	¼ tsp

Batter Preparation

- 1 Take a 5-inch round cake tin. Grease inside lightly with oil and line the bottom with baking paper.
- 2 Mix 180g premix with your liquid (water/milk) using a whisk until smooth.
- 3 Add the oil and vanilla essence. Mix gently until just combined. Do NOT overmix!
- 4 Pour into the lined tin and tap the tin twice on the counter to release large air bubbles.

Baking Methods

METHOD	TEMPERATURE	TIME	KEY SETTINGS
Oven (OTG/Convection)	170°C	20–25 min	Lower rack, Lower rod ON, Fan ON
Stovetop (Tawa/Kadhai)	Low-Medium Flame	25–30 min	Ring stand inside kadhai, tight lid

Cooling, Storage & Handling

- 1 Let the cake rest in the tin for 1 hour after baking. Once cool, it will demould easily.
- 2 For orders 2–3 days away: wrap cooled sponge tightly in cling wrap and store in the fridge. This locks in moisture.
- 3 The Golden Rule: NEVER do final icing on a cold cake straight from the fridge! Let the wrapped sponge come to room temperature first.

Flavor Variations



You can easily alter the dry premix or wet batter to create different cake bases. Master one formula and create infinite flavors!

CAKE FLAVOR	FLOUR	CHANGE FROM BASE	SPECIAL NOTES
Vanilla (Base)	130g Maida	—	Base recipe as above
Chocolate Sponge	120g Maida	+ 10–12g Dark Cocoa Powder	Always use Dark cocoa for rich color & deep flavor
Red Velvet	125g Maida	+ 5g Cocoa Powder	Use Buttermilk instead of milk/water + Red Gel Color
Strawberry	130g Maida	No change in dry	Add Strawberry essence + Pink/Red gel color to wet
Blueberry	130g Maida	No change in dry	Add Blueberry essence + Purple/Violet gel color
Pineapple	130g Maida	No change in dry	Add Pineapple essence + Yellow gel color
Paan / Rasmalai	130g Maida	No change in dry	Add Paan/Rasmalai essence + Green or Yellow color

■ PRO TIP — Fruit & Fusion Sponges

You do NOT need 10 different recipes to make 10 different cakes!

Just use your Master Vanilla Sponge and change the essence + gel color in the wet batter.

This saves time, reduces waste, and keeps your workflow simple and efficient.



03

MODULE

Creams & Cake Assembly

Ganache, Sharp Edges & Professional Finishing



Tin Sizes & Layering Guide — The Pro Formula

Never guess your tin size! Use this professional guide to ensure your cakes are always perfectly proportioned and structurally sound.

CAKE WEIGHT	TIN SIZE (NORMAL)	TIN SIZE (HEIGHTENED)	LAYERS
Half Kg	6-inch	N/A	3 Layers
1 Kg	7-inch	6-inch	4 (Normal) / 5 (Heightened)
2 Kg	8-inch	7-inch	TBD based on height

The Science of Whipping Cream

	DAIRY CREAM	NON-DAIRY WHIPPING CREAM
Source	Cow's milk fat	Vegetable fats
Texture	Rich and very heavy	Light, smooth, bright white
Use Case	Entremets, Mousse cakes (small bites)	Birthday cakes, frosting (professional standard)
Weather Stability	Melts quickly — difficult in heat	Holds shape better in warm weather
Recommended Brands	Premium desserts only	Tropolite, Silver Mark

Storage & Thawing Rules

1	Always store unopened or leftover un-whipped cream in the freezer .
2	Transfer from freezer to fridge the night before your baking session.
3	The cream must be >100% liquid but extremely chilled before whipping. Never whip cream with ice crystals.
4	Once whipped, cream lasts about >1 week in the fridge . Keep tightly covered with cling wrap.

How to Whip Cream Perfectly — The 'Bowl Flip' Test

Equipment: Electric hand beater — minimum **250W to 300W**. Quantity for a standard half-kg cake: **240g–250g chilled liquid non-dairy cream**.

1	Pour chilled liquid cream into a deep, cold bowl.
2	Start beater on Low Speed for exactly 2 minutes to introduce small, stable air bubbles.
3	Increase speed gradually. Watch the cream reach 'Soft Peaks' — like a cloud that flops over.



4 Switch to **High Speed** and whip until you reach 'Stiff Peaks'.

5 **The Bowl Flip Test:** Flip your bowl completely upside down and give it a firm jerk. If cream stays perfect

■ PRO TIP — Large Cakes

For 2kg or 3kg cakes, do NOT whip all the cream at once!

Whip in small batches and take it out of the fridge only as you need it — keeps it cold and workable.

■ WATER HACK — Professional Finishing

If whipped cream looks bubbly, grainy, or 'cracked' while working (due to heat):

Spray clean water over the cake using a spray bottle, then gently smooth with bench scraper.

The water re-hydrates the cream — instantly giving you a silky, bubble-free, professional finish!

Step-by-Step Cake Assembly

Step 1 — Preparation & Setup

1 **Anti-Slip Trick:** Place a damp wet tissue or wet cloth on your turntable/board, then place the cake board

2 **Thread Trick:** No serrated knife? Wrap clean sewing thread around the cake, cross the ends, and pull th

Step 2 — Soaking (The Secret to Moisture)

Always use **room temperature** liquid for soaking. Never use cold water — it doesn't absorb well.

CAKE FLAVOR	SOAKING LIQUID FORMULA
Chocolate Cake	1 tbsp Ganache mixed into ½ cup water
All Other Flavors	1 tbsp of the specific Fruit Crush mixed into ½ cup water

Step 3 — Layering & Filling

1 **Bottom Layer:** Always keep the original bottom layer of the sponge at the bottom for stability.

2 **Filling:** Spread an even layer of cream with an offset spatula.

3 Chocolate Cake: Add 2 tbsp ganache over the cream, spread, and sprinkle chocochips.

4 Other Cakes: Add 1 tbsp of fruit crush per layer.

5 **Flat Top:** Place the upper sponge layer (the one that was on top while baking) in the center of the cake



Step 4 — Crumb Coat & Final Icing

- 1** **Crumb Coat:** Apply a very thin layer of cream to seal in loose crumbs. Refrigerate for 15–30 minutes.
- 2** **Final Icing:** Fill piping bag. Pipe in round-and-round motion from bottom to top.
- 3** **Smoothing:** Hold sturdy bench scraper at 45° angle to the cake. Spin the turntable steadily.
- 4** **Sharp Edges:** Move palette knife from outside to center of the top surface, scraping off excess cream. H

■■ SUMMER WARNING

Working with whipped cream and chocolate truffle frosting during Indian summers is challenging.

Always work in a cool place or AC room to prevent cream from melting while smoothing edges!

Masterclass: Chocolate Ganache

Ganache is a luxurious mixture of cream and chocolate. Master both ratios and you can frost, fill, and drip-decorate any cake professionally.

GANACHE TYPE	RATIO	FORMULA EXAMPLE	USE CASE
Truffle Frosting	1 Cream : 2 Chocolate	50g cream + 100g dark compound	Filling & frosting rich Chocolate Truffle Cakes
Drip & Glaze	1 Cream : 1 Chocolate	50g cream + 50g dark compound	Beautiful chocolate drips down the sides of a cake
Brownie Frosting	1 Cream : 3 Chocolate	30g cream + 90g dark compound	Ultra-thick ganache specifically for brownie tops

The Ganache Method

- 1** Chop your compound chocolate into small, even pieces.
- 2** Heat the non-dairy cream in a pan until warm/steaming — do NOT boil rapidly.
- 3** Pour warm cream over chopped chocolate. Let sit for 1 minute.
- 4** Stir gently from center outwards until perfectly glossy.
- 5** **Sieve it:** Always sieve to remove any un-melted lumps.
- 6** **Resting:** For truffle cakes, let the 1:2 ganache rest for 3–4 hours at room temperature to stabilize.



■ Why Does Ganache Split?

- Ganache is an 'emulsion' — forcing fat and water to mix.
- Because we use non-dairy cream (vegetable oils), over-mixing or over-heating causes the oil to separate.
- FIX: If it splits, add 1 tbsp of warm milk/water and whisk vigorously to re-emulsify.



04

MODULE

Gourmet Cupcakes

& The Signature Dark Fudge Brownie



Part 1: Cupcakes & Muffins

Cupcakes use the exact same Master Vanilla and Chocolate dry premixes from Module 2. However, the wet batter preparation is slightly different for the perfect dome-shaped cupcake.

■ The Science of Cupcake Batter

- **Batter Consistency — Thicker is Better:** A cake batter is 'flowing' to stay moist for days. A cupcake is often eaten dry (without soaking). Too thin = gummy/doughy texture. Cupcake batter must be slightly thicker for a soft, pleasant bite.
- **The Vinegar Boost:** Cupcakes bake quickly in just 15–20 minutes. Adding ½ tsp White Vinegar ensures a fast, powerful rise by instantly reacting with baking soda.
- **Filling Rule:** Only fill liners 1/3 full (or just under half). Cupcakes rise significantly — you need empty space for piping frosting!

Cupcake Formula & Yield

180g of Master Premix = 4 Standard Cupcakes

For any quantity: Number of Cupcakes × 45g = Premix needed

Example: 6 cupcakes → 6 × 45g = 270g Premix

Preparation Method

- 1 Calculate your required dry premix and place it in a bowl.
- 2 Gradually add liquid (milk or water) until you reach a consistency slightly thicker than normal cake batter.
- 3 Mix in ¼ tsp Vanilla Essence, 1 tbsp Oil, and ½ tsp Vinegar.
- 4 Lightly grease paper cupcake liners with a drop of oil.
- 5 Fill liners only 1/3 full — leave empty space for beautiful frosting!

Baking Instructions

METHOD	TEMPERATURE	TIME	NOTES
Oven (OTG/Convection)	150°C	15–20 min	Lower rod ON, Fan ON
Stovetop (Tawa/Kadhai)	Low-Medium Flame	Start checking at 10–12 min	Same ring-stand setup as cakes

Flavor Variations & Center Fillings



Once cupcakes are completely cooled, transform them into gourmet treats with fillings and flavored frostings.

CUPCAKE TYPE	METHOD
Fruit Cupcakes (Strawberry, Pineapple, Blueberry, Black Currant)	Carve hole in vanilla cupcake → fill with fruit crush → pipe matching colored frosting.
Chocolate Truffle Cupcakes	Carve hole in chocolate cupcake → fill with 1:2 Ganache → decorate with a ganache swirl.
Gourmet Spread Cupcakes	Fill centers and top the icing with premium spreads like Nutella or Biscoff.
Dry Muffins (No Icing)	Add chopped dry fruits, pistachios, tutti-frutti, or choco-chips directly into thick batter.

Part 2: The Signature Dark Fudge Brownie

A brownie is **NOT** a cake! A cake is light and airy — a brownie is **dense, rich, and fudgy**. The recipe and baking method are completely different by design.

Yield: 4 large pieces or 9 small pieces

Total Baked Weight: Approximately 320g–330g

Liquid / Fat Ingredients

INGREDIENT	QUANTITY
Dark Compound Chocolate (Chopped)	70g
Butter (Good quality)	50g
Flavorless Oil	1 tbsp
Milk (Room Temperature)	40g
Vanilla Essence	¼ tsp

Dry Ingredients

INGREDIENT	QUANTITY
All-Purpose Flour (Maida)	100g
Powdered Sugar	55g
Dark Cocoa Powder	2 tbsp
Baking Powder	¼ tsp
Baking Soda	1 pinch
Salt	1 pinch



Preparation Method

- 1 **Prep the Tin:** Line a 6-inch square tin — bottom AND all four sides — with good quality baking paper (E
- 2 Melt chopped Dark Compound and Butter together using a double boiler or microwave until warm and smooth.
- 3 To the warm chocolate mix, whisk in Powdered Sugar, Oil, Milk, and Vanilla Essence. This is your 'Liquid Bowl.'
- 4 In a separate bowl, sieve together the Maida, Cocoa Powder, Baking Powder, Baking Soda, and Salt.
- 5 **The Mix:** Add sifted dry ingredients into your liquid bowl. Gently fold with a spatula. DO NOT OVERMIX
- 6 Fold in a handful of chocochips or extra compound chunks. Pour into lined tin. Top with more chocochips.

■ Why Dry into Liquid? — Brownie vs. Cake Science

- For cakes, we alternate dry and wet ingredients.
- For brownies, we pour dry ingredients DIRECTLY into the fat/chocolate liquid.
- This allows fat to immediately coat the flour particles, which stops gluten from forming.
- Less gluten = a dense, meltingly fudgy brownie rather than a fluffy, dry cake!

■ Making Nutty Brownies — The Flour Trick

Toss chopped nuts (Hazelnut, Walnut, Dry Fruits) in ½ tbsp of dry flour before folding into batter.

The flour creates a rough friction layer around the heavy nuts, preventing them from sinking to the bottom!

Baking the Brownie

Brownies require heat from ALL directions to get that famous crinkly, shiny top.

Bake ONLY in Oven/OTG — NOT on stovetop

Settings: BOTH Rods ON, Fan ON

Temperature: 170°C | Time: 25–30 minutes

Test: Toothpick should come out with a few thick, moist crumbs — NOT completely clean like a cake!

Cooling, Frosting & Decoration

- 1 **Patience is Key:** Let brownie cool completely to room temperature in the tin. Then grab the edges of bu
- 2 Cut into 4 or 9 pieces.
- 3 **Brownie Ganache Frosting:** Make special ultra-thick ganache using 3:1 ratio (90g chocolate + 30g crea
- 4 **Gourmet Alternatives:** Spread Hazelnut/Nutella or melted Biscoff over the top instead of ganache.



■■ GOLDEN RULE — Brownie Storage

NEVER store brownies in the fridge!

The cold temperature turns them into hard, unpleasant bricks due to the high butter and chocolate content.

Store in an airtight container at **ROOM TEMPERATURE** — they stay delicious for 4–5 days!



05

MODULE

The Art of Chocolates

Theory, Mix-ins, Center-Filled & Professional Storage



Part 1: Chocolate Theory & Science

What Is Chocolate?

True chocolate comes from the **cacao bean**. After harvesting and roasting, it is ground into cocoa liquor, which is then separated into **cocoa solids** (powder) and **cocoa butter** (fat). The combination and processing of these elements determines the type and quality of chocolate.

	COUVERTURE (REAL CHOCOLATE)	COMPOUND CHOCOLATE
Fat Used	Pure Cocoa Butter	Vegetable fats (Cocoa butter replaced)
Cost	Expensive	Much cheaper — accessible
Tempering Required?	YES — complex thermometer process	NO — simply melt and mold
Mouth Feel	Perfect melt-in-mouth	Good, slightly less refined
Shine / Snap	Brilliant after tempering	Good with polycarbonate molds
Recommended For	Premium artisan chocolates	Commercial home production
Brands in India	Callebaut, Valrhona	Vanleer (Premium), Morde (Standard)

Choosing the Right Molds

MOLD TYPE	BEST FOR	AVOID FOR
Plastic (Polycarbonate)	ALL chocolates — brilliant shine, easy demolding,	MANDATORY for center-filled chocolates
Silicone Molds	Small decorations: fondant/chocolate letters, cake toppers	Center-filled chocolates — too flexible, doesn't give

■ ■ THE GOLDEN RULE OF CHOCOLATE — Water is the Enemy!

Even a **SINGLE DROP** of water or steam will cause the chocolate to 'Seize.'

Seizing: sugar in the chocolate absorbs the water, turning smooth melted chocolate into a hard, grainy paste that **CANNOT** be fixed.

Ensure your bowls, spatulas, and molds are **100% BONE-DRY** before starting!

Part 2: Melting Techniques

Method 1 — The Double Boiler

1	Fill a saucepan with 1 inch of water and bring to a gentle simmer.
2	Place a heatproof glass or steel bowl over the pan. The bottom of the bowl must NOT touch the water.



- 3 Add finely chopped compound to the bowl. The gentle steam heats the bottom of the bowl and melts the chocolate.
- 4 Stir gently until completely smooth.

Method 2 — The Microwave Method

- 1 Place chopped compound in a microwave-safe plastic or glass bowl.
- 2 Heat for 30 seconds on normal power. Take out and stir.
- 3 Heat for another 15 seconds and stir. Repeat in 10–15 second bursts until completely smooth.
- 4 NEVER heat for a minute straight — the chocolate will burn and turn bitter!

Part 3: Basic Mix-In Chocolates

Storage for plain chocolates: Fridge, up to **1 month**.

1. Roasted Almond / Dry Fruit (The Best-Seller)

- 1 Chop almonds into 4–5 small pieces.
- 2 In a heavy-bottomed pan, melt 1 tsp butter. Add almonds and roast on medium flame until slightly brown and nutty.
- 3 CRUCIAL: Immediately transfer to a cool bowl so they don't burn in the hot pan. Let them come to room temperature.
- 4 Fold cooled nuts into melted dark or milk chocolate.
- 5 Spoon into plastic molds. Tap mold firmly on counter 3–4 times to force air bubbles to the top.
- 6 Freeze for 10 minutes to set. Demold immediately.

2. Crunchy Rice Crispies & Butterscotch

Rice Crispies: Buy readymade white bakery crispies. Test: if they feel soft, dry-roast for 1 minute. Mix into melted chocolate and mold.

Butterscotch: Use readymade butterscotch praline chunks. Crush slightly to fit the mold, mix with milk or white chocolate, and mold.

3. Unique Indian Fusion Flavors

FLAVOR	RECIPE
Orange Crunch	Crush orange hard candies into semi-chunks (NOT powder) and mix into white compound.
Chai Masala	Stir instant Chai Premix powder directly into melted white chocolate for an Indian fusion treat!



Part 4: Center-Filled Chocolates

Premium chocolates with a **hard outer shell** and **soft, flowing center**. Always use a deep-cavity polycarbonate mold for these.

The Shell Technique — Foundation for ALL Filled Chocolates

- 1 Clean your plastic mold thoroughly with a dry cotton cloth.
- 2 Pour room-temperature melted chocolate into cavities, filling them to the top. Tap firmly.
- 3 Wait approximately 60 seconds to let a thin shell set against the cold plastic walls.
- 4 **Flip it!** Turn the mold upside down over your chocolate bowl to drain out the excess wet chocolate. Tap.
- 5 Use a bench scraper to scrape the top of the mold completely clean.
- 6 Place in freezer for 10 minutes. You now have perfect empty chocolate shells!

Recipe 1 — Chocolate Truffle Bomb

Use your **1:2 Truffle Ganache** from Module 3 — must be at room temperature before piping.

- 1 Pipe ganache into set shells. Leave a 2mm gap at the top — overfilling prevents proper sealing!
- 2 Freeze for 10 minutes.
- 3 **Sealing Trick:** Lightly blow warm air from a hair dryer over the mold for 2 seconds to soften the top edge.

Recipe 2 — Fruit Centers (Blueberry, Strawberry, Paan)

Always use **White Compound** for fruit flavors — it acts as a blank canvas, allowing fruit color and taste to shine!

Crush Filling Formula

1 Part Fruit Crush : ½ Part Melted White Chocolate

Example: 2 tbsp Blueberry Crush + 1 tbsp Melted White Chocolate

Fill the white chocolate shells with the crush mixture, freeze, seal with white chocolate, and demold.

Recipe 3 — Gourmet Spreads (Nutella / Biscoff)

Pipe premium spreads straight into the chocolate shells. For Hazelnut Nutella: pipe a little Nutella, drop in a roasted hazelnut, and seal with chocolate!

Recipe 4 — The Ultimate Salted Caramel



INGREDIENT	QUANTITY
Sugar	½ cup
Dairy Cream (warmed)	½ cup
Butter	2 tbsp
Salt	½ tsp

- 1 Melt the sugar in a dry pan on low heat until it turns an amber liquid.
- 2 Turn off the heat. Carefully whisk in the butter.
- 3 Slowly pour in the warm cream — it will bubble violently! Stay calm and keep whisking.
- 4 Reheat gently so everything blends together well. Add the salt.
- 5 Let cool completely to room temperature before piping into Dark or Milk chocolate shells.

■ Coloring & Flavoring Chocolate — Important Science

- You CAN color white chocolate to match the flavor (e.g., light purple for blueberry).
- You MUST use ONLY oil-based candy colors or powder colors.
- For essences, use ONLY oil-based essences.
- If you use liquid water-based food colors or water-based essences, your chocolate will INSTANTLY seize and become hard rocks!

Part 5: Storage, Condensation & Transportation

The Science of 'Sweating' (Condensation)

When cold chocolates are taken from the fridge into a hot, humid room, moisture from the air collects on the cold chocolate surface. This is called '**sugar bloom**' or sweating — it ruins the shiny finish permanently.

■ Fix for Indian Summers

Always demold your chocolates in an AC room.

If no AC: demold very quickly and instantly place in an airtight container before air touches them!

Shelf Life & Storage Reference

PRODUCT	STORAGE LOCATION	SHELF LIFE
Raw Compound Slabs (Cool Weather)	Room temperature — dry, dark cupboard	Months
Raw Compound Slabs (Hot Weather)	Fridge in airtight container/cling film	Months — take only what you need!



Plain Finished Chocolates	Room temperature in airtight container	Up to 1 month
Center-Filled Chocolates	Fridge	7–10 days
Center-Filled Chocolates	Room temperature	Up to 2 days
Whipped Cream (once whipped)	Fridge, covered with cling wrap	Up to 1 week
Baked Sponge (wrapped)	Fridge in cling wrap	2–3 days safely
Brownies	Room temperature, airtight container	4–5 days

Transportation Rules

- 1** **Timing:** Always try to deliver large cakes (especially in summers) and chocolates in the evening or at night.
- 2** **Packaging:** Place chocolates in high-quality cavity boxes. Wrap the entire box in cling film, then place it in a larger box.
- 3** **The Summer Hack:** Travelling more than 15–20 minutes without AC? Place the boxed chocolates inside a cooler bag.
- 4** **Client Instructions:** Always instruct the client to immediately place the box in the fridge upon receiving it.